

THE MOVE

Notice -> Pause -> Name the non-fix -> Reflect -> Mode check -> Continue or shift.
-> Ultra-short: "Not fixing yet. Listening first." -> Field line: I hear the problem, I won't fix it yet, I'll stay with the person, and I'll ask what kind of help is wanted ?

START HERE

Say one non-fixing line — "I won't try to fix this yet. I can just stay with you in it for a minute." — then listen and reflect before offering any solution.

SAY THIS

Quick	<i>"Not fixing yet. Listening first."</i>
Friend & partner	<i>"I'm not going to hit you with advice unless you ask. Tell me the part that's weighing on you."</i>
Work & leadership	<i>"Before we solve, I want to understand the impact on you and the team."</i>
Mode menu	<i>"Do you want listening first, or help thinking through options?"</i>
Own the slip	<i>"That came out more advice-y than I meant. I can just listen."</i>
Pressure & safety	<i>"We may need action, but first I want to understand what you're dealing with."</i>

AVOID

- There is immediate danger, abuse, a medical emergency, legal risk, or time-critical action
- The person explicitly asks for a concrete answer and the stakes require one
- You are using the pause to dodge a responsibility you actually have

REMEMBER

Don't treat pain as a broken object. Treat it first as a human signal.